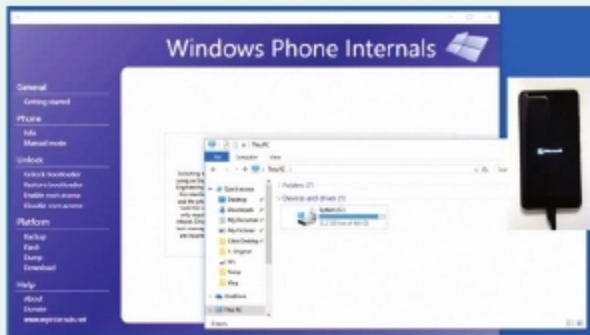


Tool to unlock Windows Phone bootloader goes open source

Windows Phone Internals, a tool built by Rene Lergner aka Heathcliff74 to help gain root access on Lumia devices, is now open source. The source code for Windows Phone Internals is now on GitHub, for the others in the Windows Phone community to further modify and develop.

Explaining the reason behind open sourcing the Windows Phone Internals, Lergner wrote on his website: “I uploaded all the source code of Windows Phone Internals to GitHub. I also created some tooling which helped me develop Windows Phone Internals. I will upload this to GitHub too sometime soon. I will still do some development, but don’t have much time for it, lately. So I hope other developers and hackers can contribute too. If Microsoft will ever release a Surface phone, I will have a new challenge and work on that.”



Earlier in 2018, Windows Phone Internals got its first update since 2015, allowing it to work on all Windows Phone 8 and Windows 10 Mobile-based Lumia devices.

The tool itself basically automates the processes required to unlock the bootloader on any Lumia, disabling security features that would normally prevent you from gaining root access. Once root access has been achieved, you can do things like flash custom ROMs, create full device backups, and use your Lumia in mass storage mode. The tool has also opened up space for developers to cook up some interesting hacks (even if their usefulness is questionable), like getting Windows 10 on ARM working on Lumia devices.

The survey revealed that 37 per cent of the developers would contribute more to open source development if their employers allowed them the time to do so. Additionally, 44 per cent of respondents don’t contribute due to a lack of right skills and 45 per cent do not know how to get started. However, less experienced and younger developers seem more open to contributing to the FOSS ecosystem, the survey highlighted.

Almost 60 per cent of developers with five or less years of experience contribute to open source, whereas the number of contributors declines for the more experienced developers, said DigitalOcean. In India, 68 per cent of the developers contribute to open source projects, the survey said.

The survey found that JavaScript is the leading programming language for open source projects with 62 per cent of the respondents using it, followed by Python at 52 per cent. The other popular languages were PHP (29 per cent), Java (28 per cent) and CSS (25 per cent).

Resin.io is now Balena; releases its open source version

Resin.io, a leading software company using Linux containers and other modern cloud technologies, has changed its name to Balena and released an open source version of its IoT fleet management platform for Linux devices called openBalena. Intel NUC, Jetson TX2, Raspberry Pi, and a new RPi CM3 carrier called the balenaFin, are the main targets.

While balenaOS is an open source spin-off of the container based device software that works with balenaCloud, the new openBalena is an open version of the balenaCloud server software. Customers can now choose between letting



balena

Balena manage their fleet of devices or building their own openBalena based server platform that manages fleets of devices running balenaOS.

openBalena’s CLI lets you provision and configure devices, push updates, check status, and view logs. Its back-end services can securely store device information, allow remote management via a built-in VPN service, and distribute container images to devices.

openBalena is an open source version of the Resin.io server/cloud platform for managing fleets of Linux-based IoT devices, which is now known as balenaCloud. The open source ResinOS distro is now called balenaOS. Resin.io’s Etcher software for fast image writes to Flash drives is now called balenaEtcher, and the Project Fin carrier board for the Raspberry Pi Compute Module is now called balenaFin.

openBalena is a ‘reduced features’ version of the commercial product. However, the components shared by both commercial and open versions are closely aligned, which “will allow us to release updates for the project as we update our cloud product, while also allowing open source contributions to flow back into the cloud product,” wrote founder and CEO Alexandros Marinos. The new deployment’s workflows and tools to accomplish this coordination will be announced soon.

openBalena offers balenaCloud core features such as “the powerful API, the built-in device VPN, as well as our spectacular provisioning workflow,” wrote Marinos. It can similarly scale to large fleets of devices. However, openBalena is single-user rather than supporting multiple users. It is controlled solely via the already open sourced Balena CLI tool rather than balenaCloud’s Web based dashboard, and it lacks updates with binary container deltas.

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